

TU-E5080 AI agents and the real world

Student projects: Next-generation digital savings interface for Nordea

Summary of the project

Design and build a functional agentic demo of a next-generation digital savings/investment experience for Nordea, aimed especially at younger customers. The brief is to move past the traditional mobile banking interface of buttons and numbers, and instead create a frictionless, conversational, personal way for new investors to enter the world of savings and investing.

This is a returning Nordea brief — a previous student team worked on the same theme in autumn 2025. New teams are encouraged to look at last year's outputs as a starting point and push significantly further.

Background & objectives

Nordea is facing increasing competition from digital-first players that are capturing savings and investment market share, particularly among younger customers:

- **Investment/savings platforms** such as Nordnet and Avanza — known for leading user experience, product innovation, low fees, strong brand and engaging content.
- **Neobanks** such as Revolut — bundling savings into a wider FX/payments/cards offering.

Despite competitors' growth in customers and AuM, none have yet truly disrupted the market with radical innovation. Nordea has the chance to leapfrog by reimagining the savings/investment interaction itself — making it conversational, personal, and trustworthy enough that a young customer feels guided, not sold to.

Why this matters for students: banking interfaces are one of the most heavily used app categories in the world. Agentic interfaces here are still nascent. There is genuine room to invent, and what works on a banking demo will generalise to many other regulated, trust-heavy domains.

Benefits for Nordea: attract and retain savings customers (especially younger groups), increase customer satisfaction, and grow AuM.

Project outline & deliverables

Concrete steps:

1. Study current Nordea, Nordnet, Avanza, and Revolut savings/investment experiences. Identify what works and what is still tied to button-and-number paradigms.
2. Look at the autumn 2025 student team's output on the same brief — extend or take a different angle.
3. Design an agentic interaction model that engages younger users, guides them into investing in an easy and trusted way, and delights them.
4. Build a working agentic demo of the experience.

Deliverables:

- A functional agentic demo of the next-generation digital savings interface
- The solution should:
 - Engage the user via a new type of interface (away from buttons-and-numbers)
 - Guide the user into the world of investing in an easy, convenient, trusted way
 - Attract and delight the user

Skills and learning focus

- Designing agentic interactions for **regulated, trust-heavy** domains
- Conversational UX for first-time investors — pacing, education, transparency
- Working with synthetic data and public information when no production data is available
- Building credible, demo-quality prototypes that a corporate audience will respond to
- Domain literacy in personal savings, investing, and consumer banking

Skills needed in the team: at least one team member comfortable with conversational/agent prototyping; one with UX/interaction design sensibility; one comfortable with the financial domain or willing to learn it quickly.

Support

Nordea will provide:

- **Course-side responsible contact** — Topi Kärkkäinen (Nordea)
- **Subject-matter sparring** as needed during the project
- **Course gala showcase** — strongest demos shown to Nordea leadership (audience includes leadership context for August Nordea top-management presentation)

Data: Students can create synthetic data to experiment with and may scrape Nordea public information from the internet. No production customer data will be made available.

Contact

Nordea responsible: Topi Kärkkäinen — Nordea topi.karkkainen@nordea.com

From Aalto Faculty: Christian Lindholm — cride.lindholm@gmail.com